

**Endicott College
Beverly, Massachusetts**

**Curtis L. Gerrish School of Business
Course Syllabus**

Course Overview

Course No: BUS209
Course Title: FactSet Financial Concepts (FFC)
Credits: 1
Class Type: Lecture /Discussion/Presentation/FactSet Certification Videos

Semester and Year: Fall, 2025

Faculty: Bethany Evitts, CFA
Assistant Professor
Office Location: Gerrish 356
Telephone: 617-877-2001 (text accessible)
E-mail: bevitts@endicott.edu
Office Hours: See electronic calendar

Catalog Description

FactSetFinancial Concepts (FFC) introduces the characteristics of four core areas of finance. The core areas covered are: Economic Indicators, Currencies, Fixed Income, and Equities. The sections are woven together from FactSetdata, news, and analytics. Students, individually or in small groups, will make class presentations using the FactSetterminal on at least one topic covered in each section.

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Explain how investors use economic indicators to gauge the health of the economy.
2. Explain the qualities of good economic indicators.
3. Identify the three main drivers of currency valuation.
4. Demonstrate how investors and businesses are affected by currency markets and how they manage currency risk.
5. Describe how yields facilitate comparison across the vast diversity of the bond market.
6. Interpret the meaning of the four major shifts in the yield curve and the meaning of curve inversion.
7. Calculate equity index performance from the performance of single stocks.
8. Identify the three types of relative valuation and the role of future earnings growth when assessing fair value.

Teaching/Learning Strategies

The course sessions will include lecture, group discussions and hands on FactSetTerminal exercises, both in class and for homework.

In addition to the in-class sessions, it is your duty to regularly (at least once per day) check your email and Canvas to ensure you understand what you are expected to complete for this class.

It is in your best interest to keep up with assignments. Please contact me with any questions you have about the content. I am here to help. If you find any concepts unclear, it is important to let me know and let me help you. I want you to do your best in this course.

Readings and Materials

The class will use the FactSet modules in video form.

The FactSet Certificate programs are free for students that access the learning information via the FactSet App/Web pages.

Required materials include: FactSet Desktop Application and Microsoft Office 365

Evaluation Methods

Student learning will be assessed through the following:

Core Section Deliverables and Presentations – 90%

For each of the four sections the student (or group, depending on class size) will demonstrate proficiency in using the FactSet terminal to access and explain relevant financial information. The deliverable will be a Power Point presentation submission on the topic assigned; with a subsequent verbal presentation of the materials to the class using the FactSet terminal.

- | | | |
|---|---|-----|
| • | • Country Economic Indicators & Markets | 20% |
| • | • Equities/ Pitch Book | 20% |
| • | • Credit Analysis Presentation | 20% |
| • | • Final Presentation | 20% |
| • | • FactSet Certifications | 10% |

Logistics/ Timeliness / Preparedness – 10%

- | | | |
|---|------------------------------|-----|
| • | • Attendance / Participation | 10% |
| • | • FactSet Certifications | 10% |

Grading

Each student will be assigned a letter grade as follows:

A	=	94-100	B-	=	80-83	D+	=	67-69
A-	=	90-93	C+	=	77-79	D	=	64-66
B+	=	87-89	C	=	74-76	D-	=	60-63
B	=	84-86	C-	=	70-73	F	=	< 60
WX	=	(Withdrawn Failed)						

Course Policies

Academic Integrity Policy: Students are required to abide by the [Academic Integrity Policy](#) of Endicott College.

AI Policy: Students are required to abide by the [AI Policy](#) of Endicott College, and violations are subject to the college's [Academic Integrity Policy](#).

Include your own course policy on the use of AI. You should include any course-wide policies, procedures for using & citing AI use, and the penalty for violations.

Attendance Policy: Students are required to abide by the [Attendance Policy](#) of Endicott College. Attendance in this course is required, including the last day of scheduled classes in the semester and the final exam. ***Students who fail to attend 3 class meetings will be dismissed from this course.***

If you are absent due to athletic contest, please have the appropriate paperwork completed in a timely fashion (*before* the game). You will not be permitted to miss class for workouts or practice.

Turnitin Policy: By taking this course, students agree that all required assignments may be subject to submission for “similarity review” to Turnitin.com, a tool intended to not just detect instances of plagiarism, but to prevent it as well. The tool is intended to help students identify passages that are unoriginal, incorrectly cited, or lacking appropriate source information. Submitted assignments may also be archived in the Turnitin.com database for the purpose of checking for possible future instances of plagiarism, additional similarity searches, and other educational purposes at the discretion of the instructor.

Student Support

Accessibility Services

Endicott College provides equal educational opportunities for all students regardless of disability status. If you believe that you qualify as a person with a disability as defined by Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) of 1990 and its Amendment Act of 2008 (ADAAA), you are encouraged to register with the Center for Accessibility Services Office to request accommodations, auxiliary aides, and/or support. The Center for Accessibility Services is located on the 2nd Floor of the Diane M. Halle Library. Please visit the [Center for Accessibility Services website](#) and you may contact Accessibility Services at access@endicott.edu with any questions.

Academic Support

The Division of Academic Success believes that every student can benefit from having a thought partner who supports their learning. We offer innovative and individualized services that motivate you as you pursue your educational goals:

- **Content and Writing Tutoring:** Work with content tutors who can help you understand, remember, and apply course content, or with writing tutors who will support your growth as writers and thinkers. Students can schedule free tutoring sessions on [TutorTrac](#) or stop by Halle Library 204.
- **Quick-Connect Coaching:** Meet with a professional academic coach for thirty minutes to devise a solution to an immediate challenge, including unpacking a difficult assignment, creating a specific study schedule for an upcoming assessment, prioritizing multiple responsibilities, and more. Students can schedule free quick-connect sessions on [TutorTrac](#) or stop by Halle Library 204.
- **Academic Coaching:** Grow your academic self-awareness and deepen your connection to your education by partnering once, twice, or three times a week with a professional academic coach to: develop and deepen academic confidence, resilience, and grit; develop time management and organizational systems and strategies; learn how to set and adjust goals; and recognize how to best utilize resources. This program has an additional cost. To enroll in academic coaching, students can email academiccoaching@endicott.edu.

- **Workshops:** Our semester workshops help students build skills in crucial areas for learning and succeeding: time management, goal setting, note-taking strategies, and metacognition. See [the website](#) for a complete list of programs.
- **Title IX 2024 Policy:** Institutions cannot discriminate based on a student's pregnancy or parental status; past or present, or any related conditions medical or otherwise. Qualified students may be eligible for academic adjustments enabling them to continue their academic process. For more information about Title IX Protections with regard to pregnancy or parental status, please contact Endicott's Title IX Officer, Christy Galatis at cgalatis@endicott.edu or at (978) 998-7746 and www.endicott.edu/title-ix

Course Expectations

For each credit hour students are expected to spend a minimum of two hours on work outside of class each week. For this **one-credit** course that means a minimum of **two hours** each week.

Students must review the online [Academic Calendar](#) published by the Registrar's Office.

Class attendance is expected of all students up to and including the last day of scheduled Finals in the semester. Students must plan accordingly.

Modify the credit/hours sentence above as needed. Additional course expectations may be added to this section.

By taking this course, students agree that all required assignments *may be* subject to submission for "similarity review" to Turnitin.com, a tool intended to not just detect instances of plagiarism, but to prevent it as well. The tool is intended to help students identify passages that are unoriginal, incorrectly cited, or lacking appropriate source information. Submitted assignments may also be archived in the Turnitin.com database for the purpose of checking for possible future instances of plagiarism, additional similarity searches, and other educational purposes at the discretion of the instructor. For more information, [please review the Privacy and Security guide at Turnitin.com](#).

Course Expectations

For each credit hour, students are expected to spend a minimum of two hours on work outside of class each week. For this one credit course that means a minimum of two hours each week.

Students must review the Academic Calendar published by the Registrar's Office online at: <http://tinyurl.com/hbmfywj>.

Topic Outline and Timeline

The table below shows a rough guide for the topics and activities to be covered in this course. Please note that, starting in week 1, you have something due almost EVERY week!

Any changes to this schedule will be announced via Canvas. Be sure to log into Canvas regularly (at least once per day) to check for announcements and to keep pace with the assignments that are due.

Week	Week of	Assignments Due <i>Weekly Class Topic(s)</i>
1	Sept 8th	<i>Introductions & FactSet Certification Expectations</i> <i>FactSetLogin</i> <i>Company Scavenger Hunt</i>
2	Sept 15th	<i>Exploring the Markets with FactSet</i> <i>Economic Indicators</i> <i>Assignment of Economic Indicators topics</i>
3	Sept 22rd	<u>Economic Indicator Discussion</u> <u>Wealth Mgmt : News & Market Performance</u>
4	Sept 29th	<u>Economic Indicator Presentation</u>
5	Oct 6th	Equity Market

Week	Week of	• Assignments Due - o <i>Weekly Class Topic(s)</i>
		- o <i>Equity Markets</i> - o <i>Equity Research</i> - o <i>Accounting and Company Information</i>
6	Oct 13 th	No Class
7	Oct 20 th	o <u>Equity Market Industry Analysis and ESG</u>
8	Nov 3 th	o Equity Presentations
9	Nov 3 th	Fixed Income – Introduction & Credit Analysis
10	Nov 10 th	<i>No Class</i>
11	Nov 17 th	o <u>Fixed Income Market Presentations</u>
12	Nov 24 th	• No Class - Thanksgiving
13	Dec 1 st	• <u>FactSetFinancial Concepts Final Paper and Presentation</u>
14	Exam	• FactSetFinancial Concepts Certifications

Subject to Change Statement

The syllabus sets forth my course objectives and my best estimate of what we will be able to cover during the semester. In order to tailor the course to the specific needs of the students, I might modify the syllabus during the semester; for this reason, it is possible that not all of the material will be covered and/or that additional material may be assigned.